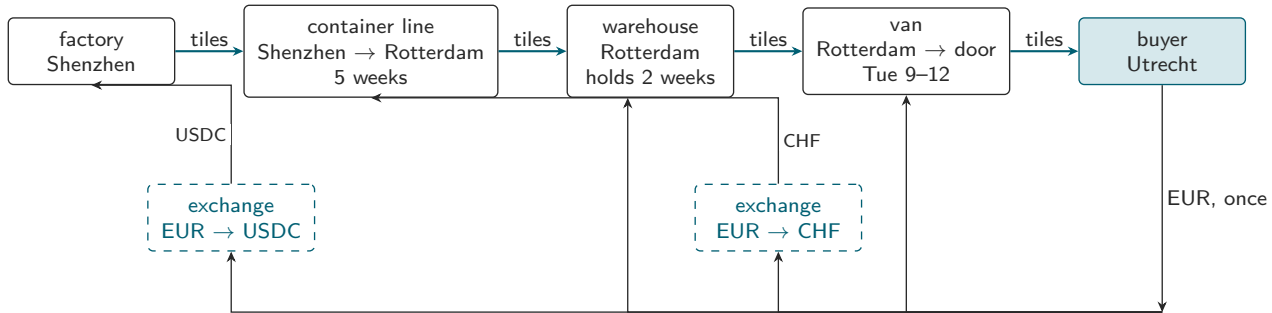




Not a loop. The buyer pays *once*; clearing splits the euro give four ways at the per-leg prices, two of them through exchanges, because the factory is paid in USDC and the shipper in francs. Goods legs run one way, payment legs the other, and every node nets to zero on its own scale. That conservation, not the cycle, is the invariant: the cleared object is a *circulation*, and a loop is its smallest case.